interfere with the said company, I will stop my preaching and close my connection with the company. The directors are not able to guarantee this.'[57] 'If the general public tells me to go away or stop preaching,' he said, he would agree but would never submit to a minority.

The next morning, VOC, Siva and Padmanabha Aiyangar appeared in the collector's court at Tirunelveli. Though summoned at 10 a.m., the proceedings did not begin until mid-afternoon. Wynch demanded that they show cause why they should not be bound over for peace. VOC arguing his own case, refused to provide security. Rather, he demanded that the proceedings be adjourned enabling him to approach the high court for transfer of the case. Wynch was not only willing to adjourn but even ready to withdraw action under the CrPC if only VOC promised to go away to Bombay for six months. But VOC was defiant. Sparks flew. The heated exchange between VOC and Wynch is immortalized in Subramania Bharati's songs, published in the *India* (4 April 1908). At the end of the day, despite it being late, VOC proceeded to the Nellaiyappar temple and joined the procession to commemorate Bipin Chandra Pal's release. Speaking at the Tai Poosa Mantapam on the banks of the Tamiraparani—it was 9 p.m.—a valiant VOC summed up what transpired during the day.[58] Continuing his speech, he reiterated the essentials of the Swadeshi movement: boycott and constructive Swadeshi. In elaborating on this, he poured scorn on 'some leaders'. Describing them as 'pseudo-patriots'—no doubt it perfectly described the directors of SSNCo—he ridiculed them for advocating Swadeshi but without recourse to boycott. This, he said, was akin to trying to practise virtue without giving up vice or championing truth without avoiding lies—these were 'manifestly irreconcilable things'. In a pointed attack on the drain of wealth, he asked how India would prosper if Rs 180 crore worth of wealth was shipped away to a country 6,000 miles away.[59]

Despite Wynch's warning, VOC proceeded to Tuticorin early the next day where he led a procession in honour of Bipin Chandra Pal's release—an event that had been postponed due to Wynch's summons. The Tuticorin visit was another demonstration of his hold over the public. VOC returned